

Benzoic Acid and Its Derivatives Diet



What is it?

People with allergic contact dermatitis can be so sensitive to their allergen that they must avoid skin exposure AND ingestion (eating) of the chemical. This type of allergy could cause dermatitis on the eyelids, hands, face, around the mouth, or at the skin folds (armpits, groin). Some people may have dermatitis all over their bodies.

For some people allergic to benzoic acid, a diet low in benzoic acid can reduce the likelihood of skin reactions. The level of benzoic acid required to produce a response is unknown and can vary from patient to patient. A two-month trial of removing foods and beverages that contain benzoic acid is recommended.

Benzoic acid naturally occurs in plants, fruit, nuts, spices, vegetables, and fungi as well as in animal products. In addition to these foods that naturally contain it, benzoic acid can be used as a food additive, preservative and flavoring agent.

The goal is a low benzoic acid diet. In general, avoid fruit juices, carbonated soft drinks, jams, chocolates, pickles, baked goods, and other processed goods.

References:

Dermatitis 2012;23:248-257

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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FOODS TO AVOID		FOODS ALLOWED	
BEVERAGES			
Sodas, energy drinks, coffee, powder and liquid drink mixes, fruit drinks, juices, alcoholic mixes, lemonades, flavored teas, flavored water, sparkling water		Izze sparkling juice, La Croix sparkling water, San Pellegrino sparkling lemon or orange beverage, Martinelli’s apple juice, Mott’s apple juice, RW Knudsen juices, Indian Summer apple cider, Welch’s grape juice, Gatorade, Ocean Spray cranberry 100% juice are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
BREAD AND FLOUR PRODUCTS			
Pitas, tortillas, taco shells, bread		Nature’s Pride Oven Classics bread, Azteca tortillas, Ortega hard taco shells, Natural Ovens Bakery bagels, One Republic Artisan-Style pitas are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
CONDIMENTS AND DRESSINGS			
Goya brand canned beans, Bush’s baked beans, few frozen vegetables Prepackaged olives, prepackaged garlic, hummus, preserves, jam, spreads, mustard, horseradish sauce, hot sauce, prepackaged peppers, giardiniera peppers, pickles, salsa, salad dressings, ketchup, barbecue sauce, marmalades, mayonnaise, marinades, syrup, Asian sauces (for example peanut, wasabi, soy sauces, etc).		Heinz tomato ketchup, French’s mustard, Our Family kosher dill baby pickles, Open Pit BBQ sauce, Heinz chili sauce, Boar’s Head horseradish sauce, Smucker’s jelly or preserves, Newman’s Own salad dressing, Tabasco sauce, Tribe hummus, Hellman’s Real mayonnaise, Shady Maple Farms organic syrup, Nature’s Promise organic golden honey, LaChoy soy sauce all purpose, Krinos Kalamata olives, Pompeian red wine vinegar area all ok. Make others from scratch. Use fresh garlic and fresh peppers. Read labels for other items.	
DAIRY			
Butter, margarine, oil spreads, cottage cheese, cream cheese, cheese with spices, blue cheese gorgonzola cheese, dips, ice cream, ice cream cakes, custard, pudding, powdered shake mixes, milkshakes, yogurt with added cinnamon or fruits.		Daisy sour cream or cottage cheese, Yoplait original yogurt, Dean’s whipping cream, Philadelphia original cream cheese, Dannon all-natural yogurt, Land O’Lakes butter, Kraft cheese, Edy’s fruit bars, Häagen Dazs ice cream are all ok. Pure butter and shortening are ok. Pure vegetable oils, lard and drippings are ok. Margarine is ok Make home-made dressings. All types of milk, cream, sour cream and fromage frais. Read labels for other items.	
DESSERTS AND SNACKS			
Cake, cake mix, brownie, brownie mix, cookies, doughnuts, pastries, pies, cobblers, cream puffs, cheesecake, dessert toppings, pie fillings, sorbets, popsicles, Jell-O, candy, fruit snacks. Dry roasted nuts, Bombay mix, spicy nuts, or flavored crisps.		Jell-O pudding or gelatin cups, Nabisco Teddy Grahams, Edy’s fruit bars, Pepperidge Farm cookies are all ok. Baked goods (home-made or manufactured without cinnamon or benzoate derivatives). Plain nuts, seeds and plain or salted chips without spices or benzoate derivatives. Read labels for other items.	

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FOODS TO AVOID		FOODS ALLOWED	
FRUITS AND VEGETABLES			
Canned or prepackaged fruit and vegetables (frozen or non-frozen). Dried fruit, fruit sauce. Avocado, pumpkin, kidney beans, soy beans, spinach, berries (blackberries, cranberries, blueberries, strawberries, raspberries), prunes, peaches, papaya, nectarines, tomato puree and sundried tomatoes. Jams and marmalades, fruit sauces (toppings, tis, or jars or fruit and fruit puree)		Ocean Spray Craisins, Sun-Maid raisins are ok. Freeze fresh vegetables and fruit not listed on the left. Read labels for other items.	
MEATS			
Prepackaged meats (for example ham, shredded beef, etc.)		Oscar Mayer bacon, Bob Evans sausage, Oscar Mayer Deli Fresh turkey, ham, or chicken, Jimmy Dean all-natural pork sausage, Vienna beef franks, or Polish sausage, Buddig packaged meats are all ok. Any plain fresh or frozen meat. Read labels for other items.	
PREPARED MEALS			
Cereal bars, breakfast bars, pancakes, General Mills Fruity Cheerios, waffles, fruit/oatmeal bars, protein bars, prepackaged breakfast sandwiches. Prepackaged hard-boiled eggs. Instant microwaveable foods		Bisquick baking and pancake mix, Kellogg’s Nutri-Grain cereal bars, Health Valley cereal bars, Kashi TLC Soft Baked cereal bars are all ok. Boil eggs at home. Cook at home. Read labels for other items.	
SEAFOOD			
Canned or prepackaged fish		Blue Star Crabmeat, Gorton’s brand frozen fish are both ok. Any plain fresh or frozen fish. Read labels for other items.	
SOUPS			
Canned, prepackaged, instant soups		Some Progresso brand canned soups, Swanson chicken and beef broth are ok. Make from scratch. Read labels for other items.	
SPICES, SEASONINGS, AND COOKING PRODUCTS			
Sweet ‘N Low liquid sweetener, other liquid artificial sweeteners, Mrs. Dash marinades, food colorings and dyes, artificial flavorings, packaged seasoning mixes. Imitation chocolate and chocolate substitutes, cinnamon sticks, Cola cubes, cola chewits.		Use sugar, natural flavors, and individual seasonings. For example, honey, molasses, icing sugar, etc. Avoid food coloring. Read labels for other items.	
MEDICATIONS, VITAMINS, AND SUPPLEMENTS			
Pedialyte solution. Medications with coated tablets or liquid form, protein bar, proteins hakes and mixes, vitamins (hard and chewable), aloe vera juices		Many uncoated pills, EAS 100% whey protein are ok. Read labels for other items.	
OTHER			
Fast foods			

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